

Title

Mandala artistic practice as a supportive intervention for psychological well-being in family members of palliative care patients

Abstract

Background: Family members of patients with terminal illness often experience anxiety, depression, and existential distress during caregiving transitions. Creative interventions offer potential psychological benefits. **Objective:** To evaluate mandala-based artistic engagement for enhancing psychological well-being in palliative care family members. **Methods:** A total of 84 family caregivers (mean age 52 years; 71% female) were randomized to either weekly mandala drawing/coloring sessions for 4 weeks (n=42) or standard care control (n=42). Sessions occurred in quiet settings with art materials provided. The Psychological Well-Being Scale was administered at baseline and week 4; secondary measures included the Spiritual Well-Being Scale and quality-of-life visual analog scales. **Results:** Intervention participants demonstrated significant improvements in psychological well-being scores (mean change +8.3 points versus +1.2 points control, $P = 0.001$). Spiritual well-being also improved in the intervention group (mean change +6.7 points versus +0.9 points control, $P = 0.003$). Participants reported high satisfaction (92% rated intervention as 'helpful' or 'very helpful'), with qualitative feedback emphasizing stress relief, improved mood, and spiritual connection. No adverse events were reported. **Conclusion:** Weekly mandala artistic engagement significantly enhances psychological and spiritual well-being in family members supporting palliative care patients, offering a simple, scalable, and culturally accessible intervention.